

SAP Labs Interview Experience

Role : Developer Associate

Total Rounds: 5

Date: 18th August 2025

It all began on a nervous evening in front of my laptop, preparing for the SAP Labs interviews.

I had read countless experiences from other candidates, and now it was finally my turn to create one of my own.

From the very first online test to the final HR discussion, here's a step-by-step look at how my SAP Labs interview unfolded and the lessons I took away.

About Company:

About SAP Labs India

SAP Labs India is a major research and development hub of SAP, located in **Bengaluru, Gurgaon, Pune, Mumbai, and Hyderabad**. The Bengaluru campus is the largest, focusing on **AI solutions and enterprise technology** with a strong, customer-centric approach.

About SAP

SAP (**Systems, Applications, and Products in Data Processing**) is a **global leader in enterprise software**, helping businesses manage operations like finance, supply chain, and data analytics. Headquartered in **Germany**, SAP has been driving innovation for **over 50 years** and works with companies in nearly every industry worldwide.

[Learn the basic concepts of **SAP ERP products** and the **SAP HANA database** they use. They usually don't ask direct questions from these

topics, but having this knowledge can give you a **slight edge over other candidates** by showing genuine interest in the company.]

Selection Process

1. Online Assessment (OA)

- **Duration:** 100 minutes (1 hour 40 minutes)
- **Platform:** Codility
- **Proctoring:** Both **video and audio**
- **Questions:** 2 DSA problems – *one easy* and *one medium* level.
- **Note:** Each candidate received a **different set of questions**.

Questions Asked to me

Question -1

Problem Statement

You are given an array A containing N integers, sorted in non-decreasing order.

Your goal is to transform this array by performing a series of moves. A "move" can be one of two operations:

1. **Remove** an integer from the array.
2. **Insert** an integer anywhere in the array.

The objective is to reach a state where for **every unique value X present in the final array, it appears exactly X times**.

You need to find the **minimum total number of moves** (removals + insertions) required to achieve this goal. Note that it's permissible to remove all occurrences of a number.

Example 1

- **Input:** A = [1, 1, 3, 4, 4, 4]
- **Expected Output:** 3

Explanation: The initial array has two 1s, one 3, and three 4s. You can perform the following 3 moves:

1. Remove one 1.
2. Remove the 3.
3. Insert one 4. The resulting array is [1, 4, 4, 4, 4]. In this array, the value 1 appears once, and the value 4 appears four times, satisfying the condition.

Example 2

- **Input:** A = [1, 2, 2, 2, 5, 5, 5, 8]
- **Expected Output:** 4

Explanation:

1. Remove 8
 2. Remove 2 once
 3. Add two times 5
- Total moves : 4

Example 3

- **Input:** A = []
 - **Expected Output:** 0
-

Question 2

Problem Statement

In a city, there are N districts (numbered from 0 to $N-1$) connected by M streets. The street network is described by two arrays, A and B , where each pair $(A[K], B[K])$ represents a street between two districts.

There are also L hospitals in the city, and their locations are given by an array H .

When an ambulance is needed in a district, it is sent from the hospital that can reach the district via the shortest possible route. It takes exactly 1 minute to travel along any single street.

The task is to find the **longest time** required for an ambulance to reach any district in the city. This means you must:

1. For every district, find the shortest possible travel time from its **closest** hospital.
2. From all these shortest times, find the maximum value.

If any district cannot be reached by an ambulance (i.e., it's not connected to any district with a hospital), the function should return -1.

I don't remember the example for this question

Similar question : <https://www.chegg.com/homework-help/questions-and-answers/city-n-districts-numbered-0-n-1-connected-m-streets-connections-described-two-arrays-b-len-q92788342>

I solved both questions

Result of this Round :

A total of **89 students** were shortlisted for the interview.

The results came out just **one day before**, in the afternoon, so I had only that evening and the next morning to prepare.

My advice: if you've solved both problems, don't wait for the results—start preparing for the interview right away.

If you get shortlisted, you're ready. If not, that preparation will still help for the next company.

This way, even if the shortlist is announced at the last minute, you'll already feel confident and ready.

Technical Interview – 1

Duration: For me, this round lasted about **1 to 1 hour 15 minutes**.

1. Introduction & Project Discussion

The interview started with the classic question: **"Introduce yourself."** Next, the interviewer asked me to explain my **second project** listed on my resume.

I began explaining my project, and he seemed **very satisfied** with my explanation.

Later, he moved on to the **technical part** and asked, **"Are you good in Java?"**

I confidently replied, **"Yes, I'm good at it."**

Questions asked related to java

1.Exception Handling

2.Whether try block cant exist with/without catch and finally

3.checked exception and unchecked exception with examples for them

4.Throw vs throws

5.finally keyword

6.Oops concept in java

My Advice:

Don't just memorize OOP theory from sites like GFG. Instead, **focus on understanding the concepts clearly** and, if possible, **relate them to your project**. Explaining OOP concepts **with examples from your own project** makes it easier for the interviewer to understand and shows practical knowledge.

7. Polymorphism one example code question

```
class Calculator {  
    int sum(int a, int b) {  
        return a + b;  
    }  
    long sum(long a, int b) {  
        return a + b;  
    }  
}
```

Calculator.sum(10,5)

Which method will be called

I said sum(int a, int b)

Why long sum() isn't called he asked

Then what happens if only we have long sum()

I said if we have only long sum() then long sum will be called

He asked me to explain the reason

Java looks for **exact type matches** first.

If no exact match, it considers **widening conversions** (int → long, float → double, etc.).

8. Wrapper class

we moved on to the **DSA part**. I was given **four standard problems**:

1. Binary Search
2. Set Matrix Zeros
3. Find all permutations of an integer array
4. Merge Sort

I was asked to **write code for all four problems** and also **explain each solution with a dry run**.

I managed to **solve all the problems**, but I struggled a bit with the **dry run of the recursion in the permutation problem**, even though it's a standard question from Striver.

The good part was that the **interviewer helped me a lot** throughout the session, guiding me when needed, which made the experience much smoother.

Then he asked me whether you have any questions

At the end of the interview, the classic question comes up: **"Do you have any questions for me?"**

Instead of leaving it blank, use this moment to **demonstrate curiosity and genuine interest**.

Ask about the team, the role, growth opportunities, or the projects you might work on. Thoughtful questions at this stage **leave a strong, positive impression** on the interviewer.

My Advice:

Avoid asking the usual, generic questions that everyone asks. Instead, try to ask a **unique and thoughtful question**—one that stands out and makes the interviewer **remember you**.

I asked about the **Agentic AI** and **Joule AI** that SAP is currently using in development.

NOTE:

My interviewer didn't introduce himself at the start, so at the end I asked, **"Sir, could you please tell me about yourself and your role?"** **Always remember** who interviewed you and what their role is—this information can be very helpful for **future rounds**.

[My First Round little bit lengthier when compared to others]

After this round, I got shortlisted for the **next stage**. From all the participants, only about **25 students** moved forward to

Technical Round 2

Duration: 45min to One hour

This round also started with the usual **"Introduce yourself"**.

- During my introduction, the interviewer **paused and asked about my 12th-grade marks**. He was impressed and then asked about my **favorite subjects in school** and why they were my favorites.
- He also asked about the **difference in study methods between school and college**.

Next, he asked me to **explain one of my projects**. I gave a detailed explanation, covering all aspects, and answered the follow-up questions about it.

Project Tips:

Below all the questions were not asked for me in this interview

Few of them were asked but through my multiple rejections from other company I listed them

You should be ready to answer these **common questions** about your project [Not for this company/ Its common for all company]:

1. Why did you choose this project?
2. What's the **novelty** of your project compared to existing solutions?
3. What was your **role** in the project?

4. Did you face any **difficulties or challenges** during the project?
5. How did you **overcome those difficulties**?
6. How does your project handle **multiple users simultaneously**?
7. What **security features** does your project include?

My Advice:

As a fresher, your project can add **significant weight** to your profile.

- **Avoid doing common or basic projects.**
- Try to work on a **unique project** that makes you **stand out from the crowd**.

Then, the discussion moved to **DBMS concepts**, where he asked about **joins**, including **inner join** and **outer join**.

He also asked about the **SAP HANA database**, which led to a discussion. (This question doesn't usually appear; I had mentioned HANA when talking about SAP earlier, which showed him that I have a **good understanding of the tools they use**.)

Finally, he gave me a **DSA problem: Sudoku Solver**.

- I was asked to explain my **approach**, which I did clearly.
- The **solution and approach I presented** impressed him.

He also asked about **Scrum**, since I had mentioned it on my resume.

I explained my understanding of Scrum

Apart from technical topics, we discussed **various other things**, making the conversation more engaging. This round **really gave me a lot of confidence**.

- At the end, they asked me: "Do you have any questions?"

I have asked two to three one of this was

"What advice would you give to a new joiner at SAP?"

He answered this question with a quote and we had a conversation a little longer

My Advice:

Whenever you get the chance, try to **connect with the interviewer**. Building a good rapport can leave a **positive impression** and help you stand out.

When I came out of the room

Immediately I have called for my third round

Round 3 – Techno-managerial Round:

Duration : 50min – one hour

This round also started with the usual **“Introduce yourself”**.

He asked questions

1.Challenges you have faced in your personal life

2.What are your weakness

3.he asked me to implement the oops concept in my Machine learning project

I have written the code structure for that and explained him

4.He asked about SDLC

5.Explain about waterfall model

6.Two puzzles

I was given a classic coin puzzle:

- **10 boxes, each with 10g coins except one box with a coin of different weight.**
- **We were allowed to use the weight machine only once to find the odd coin.**

I couldn't solve it initially. I tried a different approach and gave an answer using the weight machine three times. The interviewer then gave me some hints on how to solve it with a single weighing, but I still couldn't get it.

But the way I approached made him to give another problem for me to try

Puzzle 2 : <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude/puzzle-7-3-bulbs-and-3-switches/>

I have solved this and explained the approach in good manner

He was satisfied with my answer

Apart from the technical questions, we discussed many other topics. However, I felt I didn't perform up to my own standard in this round compared to the second round.

This round also finished with "Do you have any questions "

After that I have waited for the result of this round

Then they called me for final round

Round 4 –HR Round:

Duration: 20 mins

This was the final round of my interview process. As usual, it started with a brief introduction.

The HR round was more of a friendly conversation. Some of the questions he asked included:

- About my schooling and academic background
- Whether I am satisfied with MIT and how I felt when I didn't get into CEG
- Questions about my family
- Whether I'm comfortable relocating to Bengaluru
- About my CTC, base salary, and benefits
- Whether I consider myself introvert or extrovert

I also asked questions about the company and about him personally. Overall, the conversation was very friendly and comfortable, making the round quite enjoyable.

Finally I have completed all the rounds and waited for results for hours..

Finally, after completing all the rounds (around 8 PM), the results were announced, and I was **overjoyed to learn that I had been selected**. It was an unforgettable moment of pride and happiness.

That day was more than just an interview—it was a **learning experience**. I gained insights not only into technical and problem-solving skills but also the value of **confidence, effective communication, and quick thinking** under pressure.

Tips for Interviews:

Be Strong what you have mentioned in the resume

Don't mention if you don't know

Your resume will be fully questioned by interviewers during each stage

Don't get trapped

Be confident : Even if you don't know try it.

Try to connect with the interviewer whenever possible

During the interview, there were a few questions I **couldn't solve**, despite trying my best.

I realized that it's important to **admit when you don't know something**, but do it the right way [Don't blindly tell I don't know].

Don't try to cheat or guess blindly.

Instead, **explain your thought process**, show how you would approach the problem, and be honest.

Interviewers **appreciate honesty and clear reasoning** more than random answers.

Wishing you all the very best!

When you read this, you must be shortlisted for the interview.

Give your best in the interview!

Let's meet at SAP Labs.

Don't forget to **connect with me on LinkedIn.**

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/bala17/>